

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written for a single melodic line on a treble clef staff in B-flat major (two flats). The time signature is irregular, changing from 2/2 to 3/2 and back to 2/2. Fingerings are indicated by numbers 1-3 below the notes. Chord diagrams for guitar are provided above the staff at various points, showing fingerings for the left hand. The lyrics are written below the staff, with some words hyphenated across measures. The score ends with a double bar line and the word 'D.C.' (Da Capo).

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...